

COMPLETE

Embassy / Visa Center Appointment Checklist

United States - Tourist Visa (B-2) interview day, start to finish

In the weeks before

- Confirm your interview date, time, and exact location (some countries have multiple consulates - make sure you're going to the right one)
 - Complete and print your DS-160 confirmation page
 - Pay the visa application (MRV) fee and keep the receipt
 - Assemble your document folder (see the Document Checklist) and organize it in a logical order
 - Check your post's specific rules on electronics, bags, and photography at the building - these vary and are usually posted on the embassy/consulate website
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What to bring

Item	Notes
Passport	Valid, undamaged, with blank visa pages
DS-160 confirmation page	Printed, with the barcode visible
Appointment confirmation letter	Printed
Photo	If your post requires a physical copy in addition to the digital upload
Fee receipt	Proof the MRV fee has been paid
Supporting documents	Employment/financial/ties evidence - see the Document Checklist
Previous passports	If they show earlier U.S. or international travel

Leave the extras at home

Most consulates restrict or prohibit large bags, laptops, external batteries, and sometimes phones inside the building - check your specific post's rules in advance and pack light; there's often no secure storage nearby.

Day-of logistics

- Arrive at the time on your appointment letter - most posts ask you not to arrive significantly early, but security screening still takes time, so don't cut it close either
- Expect a queue and a security screening before you even reach the waiting area
- You'll typically pass through a few stages: document check, biometrics (if not done separately already), then the interview window itself

During the interview

- Answer the officer directly - interviews are short, so lead with the clearest version of your answer
- Hand over documents only when asked; you don't need to narrate your whole folder unprompted
- Stay calm if asked about a sensitive topic (a prior refusal, a gap in employment) - a clear, honest explanation lands better than a defensive one

After the interview

- If approved, you'll usually be told on the spot and your passport is retained for visa printing
- If refused under 214(b), the officer will typically explain briefly - see the Refusal Decision Guide (Premium tier) for what to do next
- If your case needs more review (a 221(g) notice), you'll get instructions on what's pending and how you'll be notified
- Track your passport/visa status through your post's official tracking system if one is provided